

∩ C15 · CLOSENESS

The Sixty-Second Embrace

The Science and Experience of Closeness

The Sixty-Second Embrace

One embrace, errand set down, only while it stays comfortable. Sixty seconds is a proposal, not a dose.

1. Usual hug first, if you have one, then step apart. Ask: full, side by side, or seated.
2. Both must say yes for up to sixty seconds. Either may leave sooner. A no means another form, a hand-hold, or a stop.
3. Before contact: I'm going to step back. No errand talk, no rocking, no harder squeeze as the timer runs, no pinning.
4. That phrase ends it at once. Early is complete, including at ten seconds. At the alarm, say it and step apart.
5. One sentence each on how it differed from the routine hug, or from having none.

A second minute only if both of you ask after you have stepped apart.

This stays nonsexual. Name desire and leave it. Do not hug toward a truce. Every second can be declined.

Stopping before contact completes the session. Skip illness, heat, or a fight still open.